Cybersecurity Incident Report

Organization: Orion Health Services
Prepared By: Cybersecurity Analyst (Graduate)
Date: 17.02.2026
Incident Type: Ransomware Attack

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1. Executive Summary

On Monday morning, Orion Health Services experienced a ransomware attack that impacted critical systems, including file servers, HR and finance systems, and partially the backup server. The attack resulted in unauthorized access, data encryption, and operational disruption.

The initial entry point was identified as a phishing email sent to a finance team employee, which contained a malicious Excel attachment. Upon execution, the malware enabled attackers to gain access, escalate privileges, and deploy ransomware across the network.

Sensitive data, including employee payroll records, patient appointment schedules, and internal system credentials, were compromised. Immediate containment and mitigation steps were initiated to prevent further damage.

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2. Incident Timeline

Time	Event Description
Morning	Unusual outbound traffic detected from internal server
Midday	Employees reported system lockouts
Midday	Ransom note discovered on shared drive
Afternoon	Investigation confirmed ransomware attack
Later	Systems isolated and response initiated

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3. Attack Vector (Initial Entry Point)

The attack originated through a **phishing email** sent to a finance department employee. Key details:

- Email contained a **malicious Excel attachment**
- User opened the attachment, triggering execution of embedded malware
- Malware established a foothold within the internal network
- Attackers gained initial access and began lateral movement

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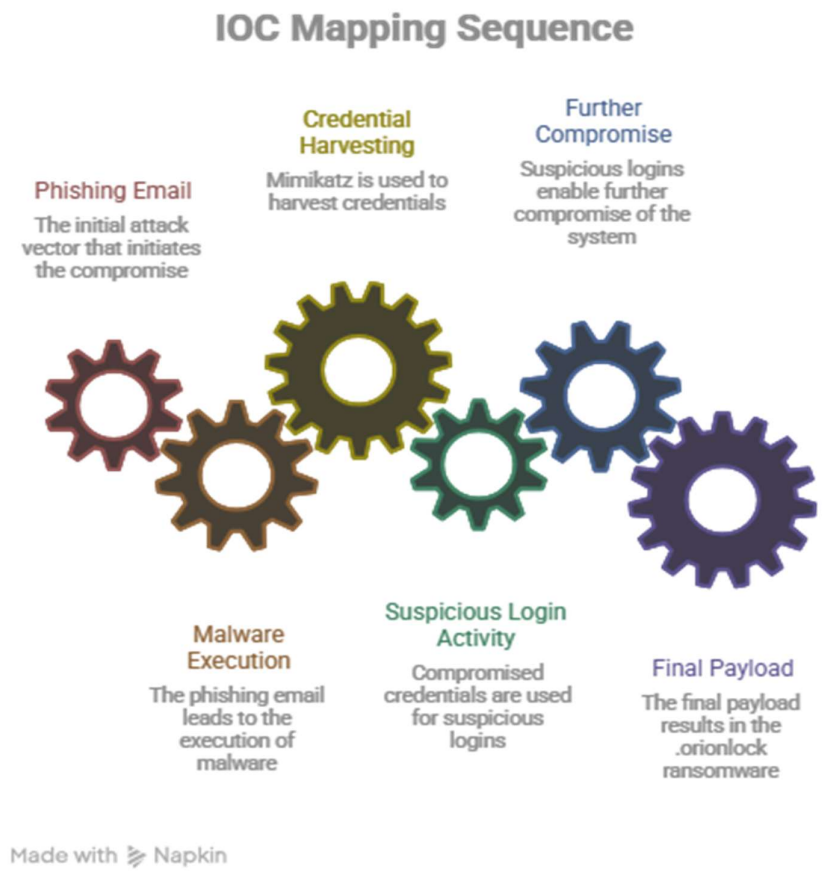
4. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

The following indicators were identified during the investigation:

- Suspicious login activity from an **overseas IP address**
- Use of **Mimikatz** for credential harvesting
- Presence of encrypted files with **".orionlock" extension**
- Unusual outbound network traffic from internal server



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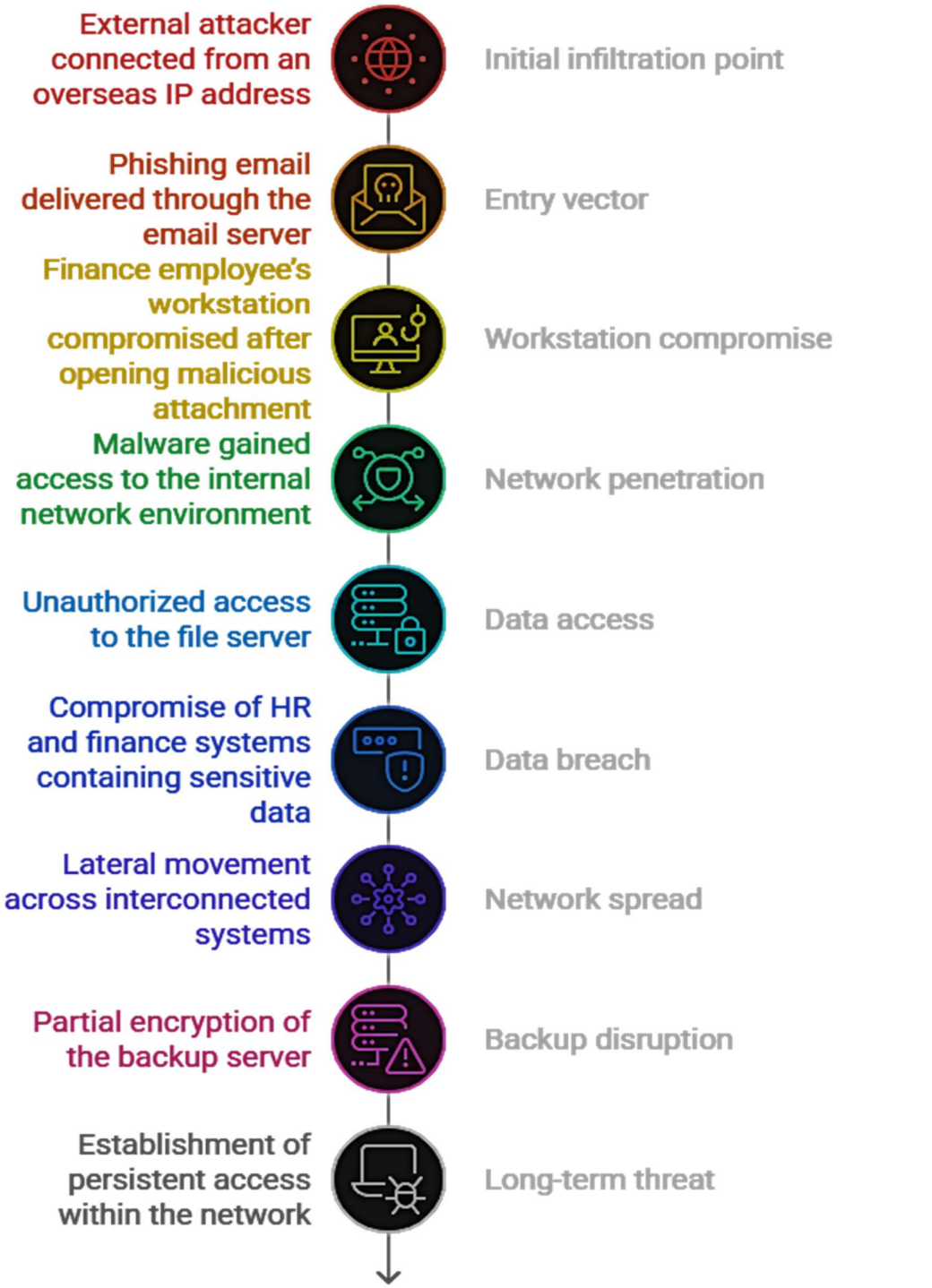
5. Systems Affected

The ransomware attack impacted the following systems:

- File Server (fully affected)
- HR and Finance Systems (compromised)
- Backup Server (partially encrypted)

Orion Health Services Cyberattack Timeline



Made with Napkin

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6. Data Compromised

The following sensitive data was accessed and/or encrypted:

- Employee payroll records
- Patient appointment schedules
- Internal system credentials

This represents a significant risk to both organizational operations and data privacy.

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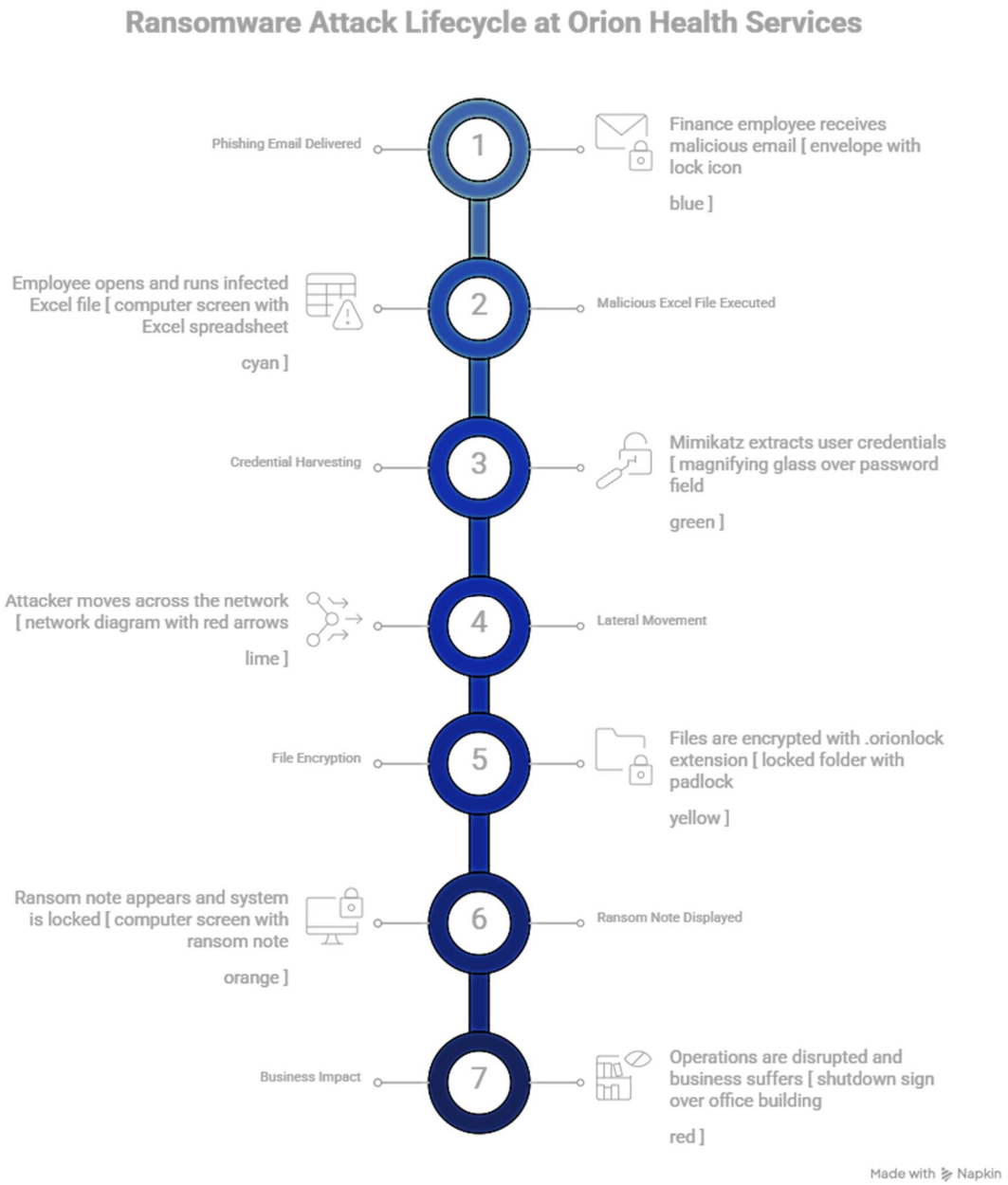
7. Attack Analysis

The attack followed a typical ransomware lifecycle:

1. **Initial Access:** Phishing email with malicious attachment
2. **Execution:** Malware executed on victim's system
3. **Credential Harvesting:** Attackers used Mimikatz to extract credentials
4. **Privilege Escalation:** Gained higher-level system access
5. **Lateral Movement:** Spread across internal network
6. **Data Encryption:** Ransomware deployed, encrypting files
7. **Ransom Demand:** Note placed on shared drive



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8. Impact Assessment

Operational Impact

- Employees unable to access systems
- Disruption of HR and financial operations
- Reduced service availability for clients

Security Impact

- Exposure of sensitive employee and patient data
- Compromised internal credentials
- Potential regulatory compliance issues

Business Impact

- Financial losses due to downtime
- Reputational damage
- Potential legal consequences

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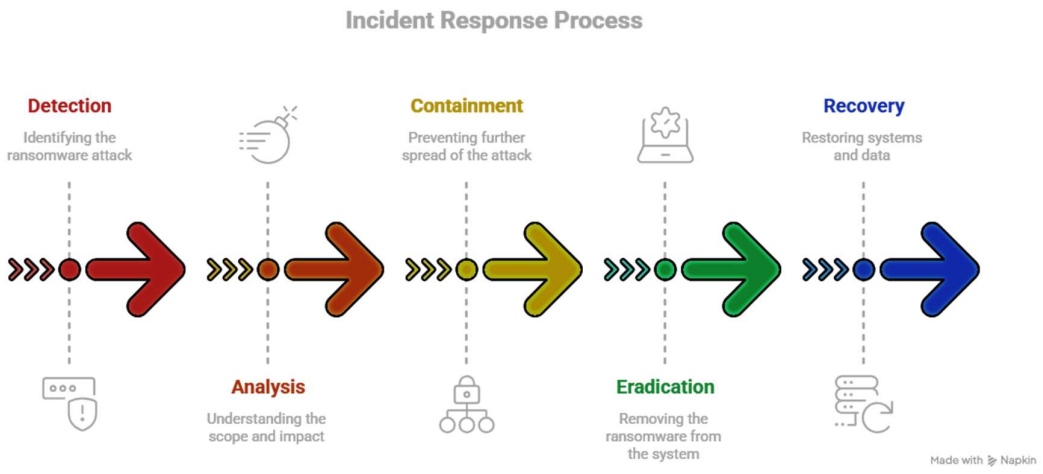
9. Containment and Response Actions

The following actions were taken immediately:

- Isolated affected systems from the network
- Disabled compromised user accounts
- Blocked suspicious IP addresses
- Initiated malware removal procedures
- Began restoration from unaffected backups
- Conducted forensic analysis



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10. Recommendations

To prevent future incidents, the following measures are recommended:

Technical Controls

- Implement advanced email filtering and phishing detection
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) across all systems
- Regularly update and patch systems
- Deploy Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) tools
- Strengthen backup security and isolation

User Awareness

- Conduct regular cybersecurity awareness training
- Simulate phishing attacks for employee preparedness

Monitoring & Detection

- Enhance network monitoring for unusual activity
- Implement SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) solutions

Access Control

- Apply the principle of least privilege
- Regularly review user access rights

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11. Conclusion

The ransomware attack on Orion Health Services was a significant cybersecurity incident caused by a phishing email leading to unauthorized access and system compromise. While containment measures have been implemented, the incident highlights the need for stronger security controls, employee awareness, and proactive monitoring.

Immediate improvements in cybersecurity posture are essential to reduce the risk of future attacks and ensure the protection of sensitive healthcare data.